

Xavier Ellery

Character Dossier

Methodical and secretly sentimental court astronomer of the Frostwall garrison on the northern border

Overview

Xavier Ellery is a court astronomer living in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border. Xavier is 60 years old, originally from Bittermoor, and is known around the east rampart as methodical and secretly sentimental. In conversation Xavier speaks softly and expects people to lean in.

Background

Xavier arrived in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border 25 years ago after leaving Bittermoor under circumstances Xavier describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Frostwall Legion; the second was the one that stuck. Today Xavier works as a court astronomer near the quartermaster's stores and is paid, when paid at all, in iron pennies.

Xavier learned the trade from Qadira Lindqvist, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Xavier's life is with Katarina Ironside, over a matter neither will explain. The person Xavier trusts most is Magnus Merriwether.

Current goal: to be forgotten by the people who remember the fire. Greatest fear: mirrors in the dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: methodical and secretly sentimental.

Speech pattern: Xavier speaks softly and expects people to lean in.

Tells: when lying, Xavier mentions Sorrow the ferret for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Xavier Ellery
Role	court astronomer
Home	the Frostwall garrison on the northern border
Hometown	Bittermoor
Age	60
Favourite dish	charred blue corn flatbread
Pet	Sorrow, a ferret
Lucky number	853

<i>Workshop password</i>	heron-ewe
<i>Mentor</i>	Qadira Lindqvist
<i>Rival</i>	Katarina Ironside
<i>Closest friend</i>	Magnus Merriwether

Secret

Xavier secretly funds an orphanage in Bittermoor and would be mortified if anyone found out.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Xavier: I am the court astronomer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Xavier: Charred blue corn flatbread. Do not tell Katarina I said so.

Visitor: Is Sorrow yours?

Xavier: Sorrow belongs to nobody. Sorrow tolerates me. Lucky number is 853, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 38

The weather turned. Xavier moved the bundle of letters indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about the missing shipment. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the east rampart, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 2, summer of year 38

Seraphine came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead. Xavier was hired to carry a copper pipe from the quartermaster's stores to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. The weather turned. Xavier moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about the tariff on salt.

Entry 3, winter of year 38

The weather turned. Xavier moved the glass float indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about the right way to mend a net. Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Xavier suspects Magnus and is probably right. Xavier won 48 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread.

Entry 4, winter of year 38

Xavier found a wax seal half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Xavier spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 80 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Xavier suspects Magnus and is probably right. The weather turned. Xavier moved the coil of rope indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about the right way to mend a net. Ursula came by asking about who really won the regatta. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 5, summer of year 38

Rowan came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Xavier moved the tin whistle indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about the missing shipment.

Entry 6, summer of year 38

A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was

written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 7, winter of year 38

Xavier repaired the brass lantern at the signal tower for Zubair, who paid in 7 iron pennies and a long story about the singing at the docks. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 8, summer of year 38

Xavier was hired to carry a cracked compass from the mess hall to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the mess hall, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone. Xavier closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the mess hall. Xavier pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Xavier repaired the sack of salt at the mess hall for Rhoswen, who paid in 71 iron pennies and a long story about the old tunnels.

Entry 9, autumn of year 38

At the quartermaster's stores, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Xavier suspects Magnus and is probably right. Xavier was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the quartermaster's stores to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Xavier closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Xavier won 27 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread.

Entry 10, winter of year 38

Xavier was hired to carry a sack of salt from the quartermaster's stores to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the quartermaster's stores, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. Orsolya came by asking about the tax on doors. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead. Xavier was hired to carry a tin whistle from the quartermaster's stores to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Xavier repaired the cracked compass at the quartermaster's stores for Ingrid, who paid in 69 iron pennies and a long story about the old tunnels.

Entry 11, winter of year 38

A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Xavier was hired to carry a spool of wire from the east rampart to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the east rampart, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 12, autumn of year 38

A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Katarina came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead. Qadira visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 13, spring of year 38

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Xavier closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Xavier spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 35 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short. Xavier found a sack of salt half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 14, autumn of year 38

Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Xavier suspects Magnus and is probably right. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the signal tower, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 15, winter of year 38

Xavier found a tin whistle half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Xavier won 65 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread. Xavier closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the census. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 16, summer of year 38

Xavier closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Xavier closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Lysander came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the quartermaster's stores, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 17, spring of year 39

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Xavier was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the signal tower to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Xavier spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 16 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. Xavier repaired the coil of rope at the signal tower for Wendeline, who paid in 80 iron pennies and a long story about the new curfew. Qadira visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 18, autumn of year 39

A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Xavier found a signal flag half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the signal tower, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Xavier won 60 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread.

Entry 19, autumn of year 39

Rumours about the quarantine reached the signal tower. Xavier pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Qadira visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Xavier repaired the bundle of letters at the signal tower for Zubair, who paid in 42 iron pennies and a long story about the new curfew. Xavier repaired the hand bell at the signal tower for Ingrid, who paid in 67 iron pennies and a long story about who really won the regatta. Winifred came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 20, spring of year 39

Tiberius came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead. Xavier won 74 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread. Xavier was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the east rampart to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Xavier repaired the clockwork bird at the east rampart for Dashiell, who paid in 85 iron pennies and a long story about the rumour of a second well.

Entry 21, summer of year 39

The weather turned. Xavier moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about the singing at the docks. Xavier was hired to carry a sextant from the frozen moat to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Qadira visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. Xavier repaired the spool of wire at the frozen moat for Brigid, who paid in 12 iron pennies and a long story about the missing shipment.

Entry 22, autumn of year 39

A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the east rampart. Xavier pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Xavier won 87 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread. At the east rampart, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 23, winter of year 39

Qadira visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. Xavier repaired the grain scale at the signal tower for Jasper, who paid in 31 iron pennies and a long story about the comet. Xavier found a bolt of linen half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 24, winter of year 39

The weather turned. Xavier moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about whether the bridge will hold. The weather turned. Xavier moved the signal flag indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about the singing at the docks. Xavier found a oilskin map half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Xavier closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Xavier found a hand bell half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 25, winter of year 39

Xavier won 69 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Xavier moved the bolt of linen indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about the tax on doors. Qadira visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 26, autumn of year 39

A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Qadira visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. Qadira visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Xavier closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance.

Entry 27, spring of year 39

Someone left a wax seal on the doorstep with no note. Xavier suspects Magnus and is probably right. At the quartermaster's stores, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 28, autumn of year 39

The weather turned. Xavier moved the coil of rope indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about the old tunnels. Xavier spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 28 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Xavier and Katarina outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 29, summer of year 39

The weather turned. Xavier moved the oilskin map indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about the rumour of a second well. Xavier won 10 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread. Xavier won 6 iron pennies from Katarina on a

bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread. Xavier spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 60 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the mess hall. Xavier pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 30, winter of year 39

Xavier was hired to carry a coil of rope from the signal tower to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Xavier won 3 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread. Xavier closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance.

Entry 31, summer of year 39

Xavier was hired to carry a copper pipe from the frozen moat to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Xavier won 64 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the frozen moat, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 32, autumn of year 39

At the east rampart, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone. Xavier spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 90 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Xavier found a clockwork bird half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Ravi came by asking about the census. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 33, autumn of year 39

Xavier won 40 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread. At the east rampart, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Xavier spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 22 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short. Xavier won 57 iron pennies from Katarina on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on charred blue corn flatbread.

Entry 34, spring of year 39

Someone left a hand bell on the doorstep with no note. Xavier suspects Magnus and is probably right. The weather turned. Xavier moved the glass float indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Qadira about who really won the regatta. Xavier closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance.

Entry 35, summer of year 39

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the new curfew. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Xavier found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the quartermaster's stores, Xavier taught Magnus how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Xavier suspects Magnus and is probably right. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice

about whether the bridge will hold. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 36, summer of year 39

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the census. Xavier read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Xavier closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Qadira visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Magnus came by asking about the quarantine. Xavier said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 37, spring of year 39

Rumours about the census reached the mess hall. Xavier pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Xavier was hired to carry a pair of spectacles from the mess hall to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Xavier for the password to the workshop. Xavier laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.